

OPERATION SILENT CORRIDOR

EXECUTIVE THREAT HUNT REPORT | SIMULATED INVESTIGATION

HALDRIC AEROSPACE • ENGINEERING NETWORK

Investigation: 20 February–5 March 2026 | Analyst: Joseph Nwoke | Assessment: HIGH

EXECUTIVE SUMMARY

A proactive threat hunt in Microsoft Sentinel reconstructed an intrusion affecting Haldric Aerospace's engineering network. The scenario advisory attributes the campaign to GREY VEIL. Suspicious remote-access activity involving s.brandt preceded a foothold on WS-ENG04; the attacker subsequently used m.richter to reach domain controller SRV-DC01. The investigation also identified activity on SRV-FILES02. The observed chain involved credential access, lateral movement, sensitive-file staging, outbound transfer, persistence and log clearing.

KEY FINDINGS

- **Initial access and lateral movement** — Failed authentication originated from 185.220.101.34. A subsequent pivot used tunnel address 10.1.96.114 to reach SRV-DC01 as m.richter; WmiPrvSE.exe on the domain controller was associated with commands originating from WS-ENG04.
- **Credential exposure** — The Active Directory database ntds.dit was staged under C:\Windows\Temp\McAfee_Logs on SRV-DC01. The investigation identified vssadmin in the database-copy sequence.
- **Engineering data at risk** — The attacker targeted C:\Engineering\Avionics\A400M_NavSys on the file server. The supplied answers do not independently establish that this entire directory was transferred.
- **Outbound transfer** — Evidence links encoded staging output win_update_kb5034.b64 to a PowerShell Invoke-WebRequest POST to cdn-telemetry.cloud-endpoint.net. The hunt's exfiltration confidence call was HIGH; destination receipt and the complete transferred contents were not independently verified.
- **Persistent access and evasion** — Unauthorized netsh portproxy configurations included an 8443-to-445 forward toward SRV-DC01. Security logs were cleared directly on WS-ENG04 and remotely on SRV-DC01 and SRV-FILES02; Sysmon remained available.

BUSINESS EXPOSURE

Potential consequences include domain-wide credential compromise, renewed unauthorized access after password resets, and exposure of sensitive avionics engineering material. Confirmed financial loss, operational disruption and the full extent of data loss are not established by the supplied answers.

PRIORITY RESPONSE

Isolate the three identified hosts; disable or reset affected accounts and revoke sessions; remove and investigate unauthorized portproxy rules; block confirmed malicious destinations; preserve Sysmon and remaining forensic evidence; and scope all domain-controller and engineering-file access. Validate security-tool alerting and monitor for renewed access.